

FINAL SESSION | REPLACES CATCH-UP SESSIONS 1-4

Finish the table in 1 class

Due End of class Tuesday. One block, about 60 minutes.

You are at Herringbone glued across the whole plywood and sanded. Base painted white. Border (B1-B4) and bands (E1-E4) cut. Cleats and shelf not started.

Today's goal A table that looks finished: the top trimmed and framed in walnut, screwed to the base, one clear coat, 4 photos. The shelf and the second coat come later (page 4).

Say this to your teacher in the first 3 minutes

"I was out sick Tuesday and Wednesday and gone Friday, so I rewrote my plan to finish in one class. Here it is. Is there anything you need to see today for full credit? And can I get make-up time to add the shelf and a second coat?"

Only your teacher decides the grade. A written plan plus asking first is the best way to protect it, and teachers often give make-up time for sick days. Also ask them to watch your first table saw cut.

The 1-hour plan

Minutes	Task	Move on when
0-3	Show your teacher this page	Teacher OKs the plan
3-9	Sand border and band faces; mark the 17" square; clear any overhang	Lines 1 1/4" in from the plywood edges
9-17	Trim the top to 17" square (4 saw cuts)	17" both ways; diagonals match within 1/16"
17-25	Glue and nail the border and bands, face down	20" outside; miters closed
25-34	Drill and install 4 top cleats	Flush with the apron top; 8 screws snug
34-37	Flip the top; clean off glue	No glue on the face; joints flush
37-43	Screw the top on	1" overhang on every side
43-46	Check rocking; take 4 photos	All 4 feet touch; 4 photos saved
46-53	Clear coat on the top	Thin and even, no runs
53-60	Clean up; turn in; hand in page 4	Teacher knows the coat is wet

If you fall behind

- Never skip** trimming the top, gluing on the border and bands, or the 4 photos.
- Skip first** the clear coat. It is the quickest thing to add next time.
- Skip second** screwing the top on. Set the top on the base for the photos and tell your teacher the screws go in next time.
- Checkpoints** Border and bands glued by minute 25: if not, plan on rule 2. Cleats in by minute 34: if not, use rule 3 as well.

Bring

Herringbone top, B1-B4, E1-E4, base, 4 cleats (or 3/4" stock to cut them), 16 screws #8 x 1 1/4", glue, wax paper, band clamp, 2 clamps, brad nailer with 2" and 1 1/4" brads, 1" pins (or the smallest brads you have), 180 paper and a block, scraper, damp rag, clear satin water-based poly, brush, clean blanket, drill, 11/64" 3/16" 7/64" bits, countersink, painter's tape, square, tape measure, pencil, phone, these pages.

Moved to later

Shelf and shelf cleats, a coat on the underside of the top, the second coat, filling pin holes and base screw holes. All of it is on page 4, in order. Adding the shelf only means taking the 8 top screws out for a while.

PART 1 OF 2 | MINUTES 0-25

Trim the top and glue on the border

Finish line The top is one piece, 20" square: a 17" herringbone field, a 1 1/4" border, 1/4" bands, and the face flush all the way around.

Why trim The herringbone runs to the plywood edges, so there is no room for the border on top. Trimming to 17" makes room, and the border pieces you already cut (19 1/2" long point, 17" short point) fit around it exactly.

Build steps

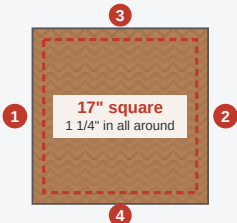
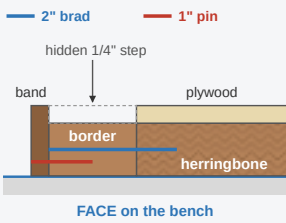
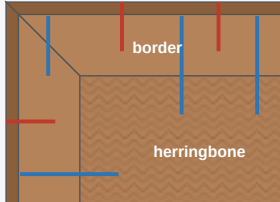
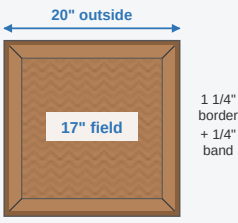
- 1 Check in** Show your teacher page 1 and ask the question in the box.
- 2 Sand the trim faces** Before any glue: 2-3 passes of 180 on a block across the top face of each border piece and band. Keep the miter tips sharp.
- 3 Mark the 17" square** Measure the plywood. If it is 19 1/2", draw a line on the herringbone face 1 1/4" in from each plywood edge, holding a square against the plywood. Not 19 1/2"? Each line goes (plywood minus 17") divided by 2 in. Put an X on the waste.
- 4 Clear any overhang** If herringbone pieces hang past the plywood, bandsaw them off just outside the plywood edge so the top can sit against the fence. Do not cut the plywood.
- 5 Trim to 17"** Table saw, herringbone face up (picture 1). **Cut 1:** the fence on the opposite edge, with the blade on the waste side of line 1. **Cut 2:** the cut-1 edge against the fence, fence at 17". **Cut 3:** crosscut sled, cut-1 edge against the sled fence, blade on line 3. **Cut 4:** the cut-3 edge against the fence, fence at 17". Check: 17" both ways and the diagonals match within 1/16". If a small bit comes loose at an edge, glue it back now.
- 6 Dry fit face down** Wax paper on a flat bench. Lay the top **face down** on it. Fit the border pieces face down around it: inside edges tight to the herringbone, miters closed. Fit the bands around the border, show edge down. Gluing face down is what makes the face flush (picture 2).
- 7 Glue and nail the border** Glue the top's edges and the miters, but keep glue off the 1/4" nearest the bench so none squeezes onto the face. Press each piece tight. Shoot two 2" brads per side through the border into the herringbone, 3/8" up from the bench, plus one 1 1/4" brad across each corner (picture 3). The bands cover these holes.
- 8 Glue and nail the bands** Same glue rule on the border's outside edges. Wrap the bands with the miters closed and the show edge on the bench. Three 1" pins per side, 3/8" up from the bench. Put the band clamp around the whole top and leave it on while you do the cleats.

Stop point at minute 25

- [] The top is one piece: 20" outside, 17" field, miters closed.
- [] The band clamp is on, and the face is flat on the wax paper.

If a machine is busy Sand the trim faces, mark the square, or dry fit the border and bands around the untrimmed top to check the miters.

Picture check

1 Mark and cut order  Cuts 1, 2, and 4 on the fence, cut 3 on the sled. Every cut after the first rides on a fresh edge, so the corners come out square.	2 Face down = flush face  The border is thinner than the top, so set everything face down. The face comes out flush, and the step ends up on the bottom, hidden.	3 Where the nails go  Blue: 2" brads into the herringbone, plus one across each corner. Red: 1" pins through the band. The bands hide the blue ones.	4 Check before it sets  Outside is 20" both ways, the miters are closed, and the walnut frame looks 1 1/2" wide, same as the original picture.
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PART 2 OF 2 | MINUTES 25-60

Cleats, assemble, photograph, coat

Finish line The top is screwed on with a 1" overhang, the table does not rock, 4 photos are saved, and the top has one clear coat.

Only 4 cleats today The 4 top cleats hold the top. The 4 shelf cleats go in with the shelf later.

Build steps

- 9 Make 4 top cleats** Already cut? Go to step 10. If not, rip a 3/4" x 3/4" strip and cut 4 pieces at 13 1/2".
- 10 Drill the cleats** At the drill press (picture 1). Side face: 11/64" holes at 1 1/2" and 12", no countersink. Bottom face: 3/16" holes at 3 3/4" and 9 3/4", shallow countersink with the head just flush.
- 11 Install the cleats** One inside each apron, 3/4" from each leg, top flush with the apron top, countersinks facing **down** (picture 2). Clamp it, drill a 7/64" pilot through each side hole with tape 1 1/4" from the tip, and drive 1 1/4" screws. Do not scratch the paint.
- 12 Check the top** Take off the band clamp and flip the top face up. Scrape off any glue at the joints and wipe with a damp rag. If a border piece or band sits proud, sand only that spot with 180 on a block.
- 13 Screw the top on** Top face down on a clean blanket. Set the base upside down on it and measure until every overhang is 1" (picture 3). Tape the 7/64" bit 1 1/4" from the tip, drill through the 8 cleat holes until the tape touches, and drive the screws snug without burying the heads.
- 14 Flip and check** Upright on the flattest bench. All 4 feet should touch. Never shorten a leg without your teacher.
- 15 Take 4 photos** Front, X side, top from above, and a close-up of the pattern and a half-lap. Take them before the coat (picture 4).
- 16 Clear coat** Stir, do not shake. One thin coat: the bands first, then the face, with every stroke going the same direction. Catch drips under the bands. Keep it off the white paint.
- 17 Turn it in** Tell your teacher the coat is wet. Hand in page 4 as your record of changes.

Stop point at minute 60

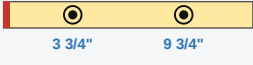
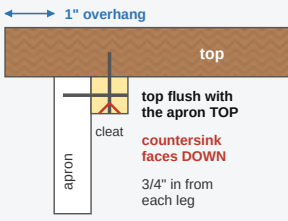
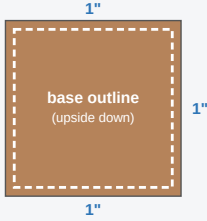
[] The table is 20" x 20" x 22", does not rock, and has a 1" overhang on every side.

[] All 4 photos are saved.

[] The top has one coat, your teacher knows it is wet, and page 4 is handed in.

If you run late Skip the coat first, then the top screws (page 1). The photos always happen.

Picture check

1 Drill 4 cleats SIDE: 11/64", no countersink  1 1/2" 12" 13 1/2" long BOTTOM: 3/16", countersink  3 3/4" 9 3/4" END Measure every hole from the red END, centered across the cleat. 2 side holes instead of 3 saves time and still holds.	2 Where the top cleats go  1" overhang top apron cleat top flush with the apron TOP countersink faces DOWN 3/4" in from each leg Side screws go into the apron. The bottom holes take the screws that go up into the top.	3 Center the top  1" base outline (upside down) 1" 1" Top face down on a clean blanket. Measure all 4 sides before drilling.	4 4 photos ☐ 1 Front ☐ 2 X side ☐ 3 Top from above ☐ 4 Pattern + half-lap Take them before the coat. Wet water-based finish looks milky until it dries.
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HAND THIS IN | RECORD OF CHANGES

What changed, and what comes later

Absent _____ (sick), _____ (sick), _____ Periods used _____ of 10 planned

Record of changes

Change	Original packet	What I did	Why
Top layers	3/4" plywood + 1/4" walnut	1/4" plywood + 3/4" walnut	Material change. The top is still 1" thick
Border size	1 1/2" wide, 20" long point	1 1/4" wide, 19 1/2" long point, 17" short point	The bands take the outer 1/4", so a 20" border would not fit
Build order	Border glued on the plywood, then herringbone inside it	Herringbone glued across the whole plywood, trimmed to a 17" square, border glued around it	Out 3 days. The finished size and look are the same
Top glue-up	Clamps; glue sets 5 hours	Glued face down with brads; the bands hide the border brads	One class left. Face down keeps the face flush
Underside	Border sits on the plywood	Border sits 1/4" above the plywood bottom, behind the bands	Comes from trimming the top. Not visible
Cleats	8 cleats, 3 side screws each	4 top cleats with 2 side screws each; 4 shelf cleats later	Time. Two screws per cleat hold the top
Shelf S1	14 7/8" square	Rail to rail minus 1/8" (about 15 5/8"), notched corners; added later	Rails sit 3/8" outside the legs, so the old shelf's screws missed it
Finish	2 coats before assembly	1 coat after assembly; second coat later	Never handle wet parts

Screws 16 today (8 cleat-to-apron, 8 top). 16 more later for the shelf. All #8 x 1 1/4".

Come back later, in this order

- 1 Clear coat** If you skipped it today, coat the top first.
- 2 Shelf cleats** Unscrew the top (8 screws) so the shelf can drop in from above, and give the top's underside one thin coat while it is off. Make 4 more cleats and drill them exactly like the top cleats. Install them inside the rails, bottoms flush with the rail bottoms, countersinks down.
- 3 Shelf** Measure rail to rail both ways and subtract 1/8" (about 15 5/8"). Cut it square with the grain running front to back, and mark FRONT. Bandsaw a notch at each corner, about 3/8" x 3/8", so it clears the legs (old catch-up page 2, Fix 2). Sand 120 then 180, ease the edges, and coat it. Let it dry.
- 4 Install the shelf** Base upright. Set the shelf on the cleats, FRONT forward, with 1/16" spacers in the gaps, and clamp it. Flip the base upside down on a clean blanket and screw up through the 8 cleat holes with the taped 7/64" bit. Then screw the top back on through the same 8 holes.
- 5 Holes** Fill the band pin holes with a walnut fill stick or filler. Fill any visible base screw holes, sand them flush, and touch up the white.
- 6 Second coat** 220 grit with almost no pressure, wipe with a damp towel, then one thin coat on the top and the shelf.
- 7 New photos** Retake the 4 photos with the shelf in, if your teacher wants them.